Feeling Whitney Catering LLC

Bar Plan & Cost Breakdown: Party October 10th (250 guests)

Summary

Your spirits are about right and the margarita supplies are solid. **Wine, beer, ice and mixers are all low.** As written, the list covers about **730 drinks**; 250 guests over 4 hours usually need **1,100-1,250**, so the current list is roughly enough for a 2½-hour party.

	Your list	With additions
Drinks covered	~730	~1,100
Supplies + tax	~$1,390	~$2,710
All-in (with bartenders + insurance)	-	~$3,800-4,100 (~$16/guest)

Assumptions: 750ml bottles, 4-hour bar, 10 lb ice bags, mid-range US retail prices, ~8% sales tax. If any of these is wrong, the numbers change.

1. Your list: amount and cost

Item	Amount	Est. cost	Drinks it makes	Verdict
Vodka	12 x 750ml	$216	~200	Good
Whiskey	12 x 750ml	$264	~200	Good
Tequila	6 x 750ml	$150	~100 margaritas	Good
Cabernet	8 bottles	$96	40 glasses	Very low
Pinot Grigio	8 bottles	$96	40 glasses	Very low
Triple sec	2 bottles	$20	50-100 margaritas	Add 1
Agave	2 bottles	$12	~90 margaritas	Good
Simple syrup	1 bottle	$8		Good
Limes	1 case (~150-200)	$50		Plenty
Lemons	6	$5		Get 24
IPA	48	$85	48	Low
Bud Light	48	$60	48	Low
Coors Light	48	$60	48	Low
Coke	24 cans	$13	~70 mixed drinks	Low
Sprite	24 cans	$13	~70	Low
Club soda	12 cans	$6	~36	Low
Tonic	12 L	$24	~100	Good
Ginger beer	12 cans	$15	~30 mules	Low
Ice	12 bags	$42		Biggest gap

Item	Amount	Est. cost	Drinks it makes	Verdict
Cups	?	$40 (500 cups)		Low
Salt and ice scoop		$13		Good
Subtotal		**~$1,290**	**~730 drinks**	
Sales tax (~8%)		**~$100**		
Your list total		**~$1,390**		

2. What to add

Add	Why	Est. cost
+44 wine (30 cab and 30 pinot total)	Wine is usually 25-45% of what guests drink	$528
+6 cases of beer (2 of each; 288 beers total)	Beer is about 25% of drinks	$205
+38 bags of ice (50 total, ~500 lb)	Rule of thumb: 1.5-2 lb per guest. Half chills beer and wine, half goes in drinks	$133
+2 Coke, +1 Diet Coke, +1 Sprite, +1 club soda, +1 ginger beer, 4 cranberry juice	Whiskey & Coke and vodka cranberry are top requests; non-drinkers need soda too	$95
3 cases of bottled water	For everyone, and it slows down over-drinking	$45
Cups: ~1,000 total, plus 300 wine cups	Guests use about 3-4 cups each	$80
+18 lemons, +1 triple sec, bottled lime juice backup		$34
Bar tools: shakers, jiggers, bottle openers, wine openers, knives, cutting boards, 2nd ice scoop	You'll want 2 bar stations	$75
Napkins, straws, stir sticks, trash bags		$25
Additions total		**~$1,220**

3. Revised total

	Cost
Supplies (your list plus additions)	~$2,510
Sales tax	~$200
4 bartenders x 6 hrs x ~$40/hr	~$960
Liquor liability insurance	$150-400
All-in	**~$3,800-4,100 (~$16 per guest), enough for ~1,100 drinks**

Brands change this a lot: Tito's, Jack Daniel's and Espolon-level spirits can add $300-600 compared with value brands.

Pricing to the client: full open-bar packages commonly sell for **$25-45 per guest** for 4 hours ($6,250-11,250 for 250 guests), leaving room for profit over your ~$16 per guest cost.

4. A drink menu that fits your list

Posting a short menu keeps the line moving and uses what you already bought:

Drink	Made with
Margarita	Tequila, lime, triple sec, agave, salt rim
Moscow Mule	Vodka, ginger beer, lime (add 2 more cases of ginger beer if you feature it)
Whiskey Sour	Whiskey, lemon, simple syrup
Vodka Soda / Tonic, Whiskey & Coke	Simple highballs
Beer, wine, soda, water	

5. Timeline (party is Saturday, October 10)

When	To do
Wed, Oct 7	Confirm the store takes back unopened bottles. Buy alcohol by the case for the discount.
Thu, Oct 8	Buy mixers, cups and bar tools. Pre-juice limes if you want to save time on the day.
Fri, Oct 9	Load coolers, cut garnishes, pack the bar kit.
Sat, Oct 10	Pick up ice. Put beer and wine on ice 2+ hours before. Set up 1-2 hours ahead. Count opened bottles at the end so you know what to return.

6. Before Saturday: licensing and insurance

If Feeling Whitney Catering is buying the alcohol and charging the client for it, check your state's rules. Many states require a liquor or catering permit for that. If you don't have one, the client buys the alcohol and you charge for bar service. Also confirm your insurance covers serving alcohol, and ask whether the venue needs a certificate of insurance naming them.